



Newsletter No 12

ROSSHOLME
KENYA

APRIL 2024

SECURING THE FUTURE OF ROSSHOLME

The first very important news is that we achieved our objective and in December, we were able to hand over the balance of money needed to acquire the land and premises within the Kiambiu Slum to secure the future of Rossholme.

Generous support from the East Africa Children's Project (EACP) and a significant donation from Rossholme's American supporters combined with our own fund raising efforts, enabled Joyce Aruga to negotiate and hand over the funds needed. She was also able to pay the legal fees and to renovate the School gates, making them wider and safer for the children.

This was a fantastic achievement and we are so grateful to all those who made it possible; we can now feel confident that the long term future of Rossholme School in Kenya is secure, located within the Kiambiu Slum where it is needed.

Such good news was sadly tempered by the death of one of our strongest, long term supporters. As well as making regular donations to Rossholme, Alan Webster, a very close family friend of the Webbs, was always so excited and involved in the development of Rossholme in Kenya. He very much hoped to be around when the first Rossholme pupil gained a place at university and perhaps passed out as a teacher or a doctor.... Donations at his funeral were made in support of Rossholme and further funding is also being made available thanks to Alan's sister Diane. As well as committing to continue Alan's support for Rossholme, she has agreed that the proceeds, from the sale of Alan's possessions, should be donated to Rossholme. Thank you, Diane.





**ROSSHOLME
KENYA**

GREETINGS FROM JOYCE...

We greet you– and we hope you all have started the new year well!

In December, with your support, we purchased the land on which Rossholme School is located in Kiambu slum - and now it is officially ours! Glory to God!

An overwhelming number of students wanted to join Rossholme for this school year, but unfortunately, we couldn't accommodate all of them. Right now our students are on April holiday break.

We are resuming on 29th April 2024.

We closed the school with 510 students, 15 teachers, one computer teacher, one security officer, two cooks and one cleaner.

We say a million thanks for all your prayers and your financial support! Without you, we would not have achieved our goal! Lots of love,

Joyce, and all the Rossholme Teachers and Students



THANK YOU TO KITTY AND CHRISTIAN FOR SHOWING SUCH SPIRIT!

Many former Rossholme pupils will remember the Rossholme Shield, a much coveted award which was presented to 'The girl showing the highest ideal of school spirit each year'. Although they may not be pupils or even 'girls', it seemed highly appropriate that Kitty Hollingsworth and her nephew Christian Edbrooke, should be presented with the shield, having demonstrated precisely this with their walk across Dartmoor last November. They raised some £1750 for Rossholme in Kenya, a very significant contribution towards the money we needed to acquire the land and premises.

FUND RAISING

Our fund raising efforts over recent months have all been directed towards the major project to acquire our own premises but, having achieved it, we still have to run and maintain the school and pay our staff. Joyce has requested that we give our staff a pay rise and, as we no longer have to pay monthly rent for the premises, we are now in a position to pay a little more for salaries. The need to fund raise never stops, particularly as we now need to develop our premises. The breeze blocks and corrugated tin have served us well but we must now look to creating a modern, up to date building with proper facilities to deliver the education our children need.

NEW TRUSTEE

Steve Swan's name has been mentioned in several Newsletters because he has been such a stalwart supporter of ours. He has now agreed to be a Trustee and we are delighted to welcome him to the Board of Trustees. As well as his own businesses, Steve's experience of building, fund raising activities, challenges and support for other charities is invaluable and we are already benefitting from his input.



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For further info please contact Judy Webb
judy@rossholmeinkeny.org

FUNDRAISING

We are a registered charity (number 1178553) which means that Gift Aid can be claimed on donations made by UK tax payers. Donations can now be made through CAFDonate which can be accessed through our website:

www.rossholmeinkeny.org

CAFDonate will also process the GiftAid or, alternatively, if donations are made directly to the charity, a GiftAid form can be downloaded from the website and returned to: judy@rossholmeinkeny.org 25% Gift Aid makes a significant difference to the donations you are kind enough to make. Unfortunately, Amazon Smile have now discontinued their donations on every purchase made.

We aim to publish a Newsletter about every 6 months so, if you know of anyone else who may be interested in receiving one by email, please let us know. In line with GDPR, we need permission for names to be on a mailing list but we assure you that it is not published anywhere; it is retained only by us and all emails are BCC'd so no list of emails is available.

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